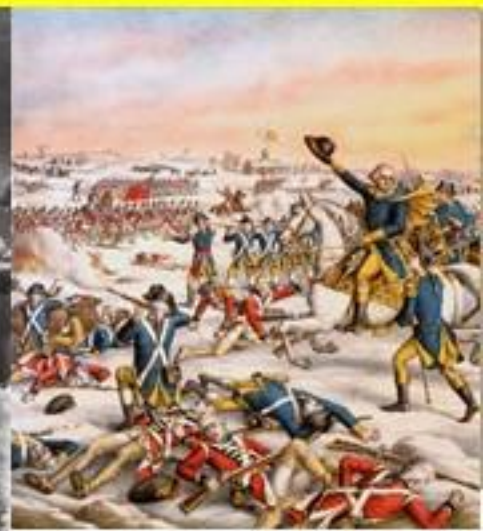


WORLD HISTORY



MODULE – 35

SECOND WORLD WAR - 2

1 INVASION OF POLAND

- 1 According to the decisions taken in the Paris Peace Conference, Poland had been made an independent kingdom.
- 2 East Prussia was separated from Germany.
- 3 Now, Hitler wanted to unite East Prussia with Germany.
- 4 Hitler invaded Poland on September 1, 1939.
- 5 Great Britain declared war against Germany on September 3.

Second World War started.



1 INVASION OF POLAND

6 Blitzkrieg:

- The German invasion of Poland was the first test of Germany's newest military strategy- the blitzkrieg or lightning war.
- It involved using fast moving airplanes, tanks, followed by massive infantry forces, to take the enemy by surprise.
- Then, blitzkrieg forces swiftly crushed all opposition with overwhelming force.
- In the case of Poland, the strategy worked.



2 CONQUESTS BY GERMANY, ITALY AND JAPAN

i GERMANY

- 1** In April 1940, Germany captured Denmark and Norway. In May 1940, Holland and Belgium were conquered. Germany attacked France and captured it in June 1940.
- 2** After the fall of France, Britain was left alone. Hence, Hitler wanted to attack England by air. There was continuous air force attack on Britain.
- 3** But the dynamic leadership of Prime Minister Churchill saved England. Germany could not conquer Britain.



2 CONQUESTS BY GERMANY, ITALY AND JAPAN

i GERMANY

- 4 Germany made a mistake of invading the Soviet Union, despite a non-aggression pact. One of the important battles was the Battle of Stalingrad.
- 5 For five months the battle went on. It involved 2 million men, 2000 tanks and 2000 aero-planes. The invading German army was driven back.
- 6 In February 1943, about 90,000 German soldiers surrendered. This was a turning point of the war.



2 CONQUESTS BY GERMANY, ITALY AND JAPAN

ii ITALY

- Italy fought against the British forces in North Africa.
- Mussolini attacked Greece and **support** captured it with German
- Yugoslavia and Crete were occupied by the Germans.

iii JAPAN

- In December 1941, Japan attacked the Pearl Harbour.
- This tragedy dragged the U.S.A. into the war.
- General MacArthur was made the **supreme commander** of the Pacific region.
- Lord Mountbatten, the Commander of South East Asia **drove** the Japanese from Burma.



3 ALLIED POWERS COUNTER ATTACK ON AXIS POWER

i ITALY

- 1 In Africa, Abyssinia was conquered by the U.S.A. from Italy.
- 2 The Italian Somaliland was also conquered.
- 3 The British General Montgomery captured Libya from Germans.
- 4 He also conquered Tripoli and entered Tunisia.
- 5 In 1942 Algeria fell. In 1943 Sicily was captured by the British and U.S. troops.



General Montgomery

3 ALLIED POWERS COUNTER ATTACK ON AXIS POWER

i ITALY

- 6 North Africa was cleared of Italian and German troops. The mainland of Italy was attacked.
- 7 There was a revolt in Italy and Mussolini was arrested, but he managed to escape with German help.
- 8 In September 1943, Italy surrendered unconditionally.
- 9 Mussolini was captured and killed by his own people in April 1945.



3 ALLIED POWERS COUNTER ATTACK ON AXIS POWER

ii GERMANY

- In 1944 the Allied forces entered into France and expelled the German army from France.
- After that the Allied forces attacked Germany from the Southwest.
- Russia invaded Germany from the East.
- On 2 May 1945 Russian army entered Berlin. Hitler committed suicide. Germany surrendered.



iii JAPAN

- Even after the surrender of Germany, Japan continued the war.
- USA dropped two atom bombs on Hiroshima (6th August) and on Nagasaki (9th August).
- Following this Japan surrendered on 14th August 1945.



END OF THE WAR

- The Second World War was over.
- At the end of the war, some 15 million Europeans were killed and 17 million civilians had died as a result of the fighting.
- All major cities were in ruins.
- Agriculture was ruined.



RESULTS OF THE WAR

- An important result of the Second World War was that it brought to an end the colonial Empire of the European countries in Asia and Africa.
- Multi-polar world became bi-polar world.
- The USA and USSR emerged as Super Powers.
- Cold War started as an ideological war between USA and USSR.



- 1** The term Total War refers to a radical departure from conventional theories of conflict.
- 2** To be able to wage total war states would have to mobilize all the material, intellectual, and moral energies of their peoples; by implication the opponent community as a whole- its scientists, workers, and farmers became justifiable objects of war.
- 3** Economic resources were stockpiled; substitute industries were set up to produce essential raw materials such as oil supply might be cut off in war; programs of civil defence were initiated to prepare home populations for attack by bombs or gas.



- 4** The second World war was a war of extremes. All the countries that fought it from either side pushed to the very depths of physical and moral endurance.
- 5** No other war in modern times made such demands on the manpower and economic product of the combatants.
- 6** The 55 million who died in the conflict exceeded the number killed in all other wars of modern age together.



IMPACT OF SECOND WORLD WAR ON WORLD ORDER

1 ASCENDANCY OF TWO SUPER POWERS

- 1 After Second World War the supremacy of countries like Britain, Germany and Japan passed into oblivion.
- 2 The period after the Second World War marked the ascendancy of the USA and USSR as military and economic power which dominated the world order.
- 3 Two powers were so great that the new “term” superpower had to be coined for them, dominated the world after 1945.



IMPACT OF SECOND WORLD WAR ON WORLD ORDER

2 IDEOLOGICAL CLASH

- 1 On the ideological front the two superpowers were in direct conflict with each other.
- 2 While the USA represented liberalism, democracy and capitalism.
- 3 USSR stood for state controlled means of production and communism.
- 4 The ideologies of the superpowers were not just different but also antagonist of each other.
- 5 Both the superpowers became proactively involved in extending their influence over the other parts of the world.
- 6 As a result, the world got divided into two rival camps after and this enmity manifested itself in the form of Cold war.



IMPACT OF SECOND WORLD WAR ON WORLD ORDER

3 ANTI COLONIAL MOVEMENTS

- 1 After the Second World War many Asian and African nations got awakened.
- 2 The anti-colonial movements in various countries of Africa and Asia got strengthened.
- 3 Many Asian and African countries were able to free themselves from the yoke of imperial powers.



IMPACT OF SECOND WORLD WAR ON WORLD ORDER

4 STAGNATION OF DEVELOPMENT IN ASIA AND AFRICA

- 1 During Second World War the destructive weapons were stockpiled by various countries.
- 2 These destructive weapons, even after the end of the war, proved to be a great threat to the world peace.
- 3 Blind Arm race continued to haunt the world and nations kept on increasing their respective defense budgets.
- 4 As a result, the scarce resources got siphoned off. The developmental processes in the Asia and African countries suffered a lot due to this.

One good effect of the war has been the **establishment of United Nations Organisation.**



QUESTIONS FOR PRACTICE

1. In what ways, and to what extent, was the Second World War "Total War"? 150 Words
2. Do you agree that Spanish civil war was the dress rehearsal of the Second World War? Elucidate. 150 words
3. What were the main criticisms of league of Nations and to what extent were they justified? 150 Words

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